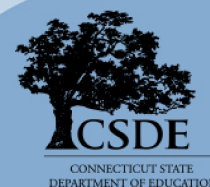


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



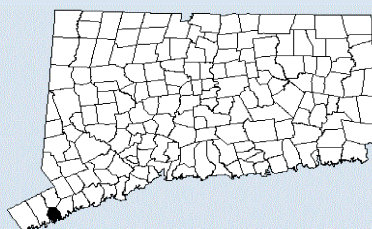
Darien School District

Dr. Alan Addley, Superintendent • 203-656-7400 • <http://www.darienps.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	4,682
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$21,805
Total Expenditures ¹	\$104,207,164

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	2,248	48.0	48.4
Male	2,434	52.0	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	256	5.5	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	294	6.3	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	159	3.4	4.0
White	3,922	83.8	49.9
English Learners	55	1.2	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	60	1.3	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	802	17.1	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	37	1.7	*	*
Male	36	1.5	*	*
Black or African American	0	0.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6	2.0	8	2.5
White	65	1.7	31	0.8
English Learners	*	*	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*	*	*
Students with Disabilities	32	3.7	21	2.1
District	73	1.6	43	0.9
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 342

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	342.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	22.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	72.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	106.2
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	9.6
School Level	28.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	7.0
Support Staff	5.1
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	20.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	34.0
School Nurses	13.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	178.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	7	1.4	1.3
Black or African American	6	1.2	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	3.1	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.1
White	488	94.2	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	5.1	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7	*	16	76.2
White	177	54.8	219	78.5
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*	8	*
Students with Disabilities	23	26.7	37	48.7
District	201	54.5	253	78.1
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	19	43.2
Emotional Disturbance	16	64.0
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	182	82.0
Other Health Impairment	212	82.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	140	88.6
District	577	78.1
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	47	1.0	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	25	0.5	1.1
Intellectual Disability	11	0.2	0.5
Learning Disability	222	4.8	5.8
Other Health Impairment	258	5.6	3.3
Other Disabilities	31	0.7	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	169	3.7	1.9
All Disabilities	763	16.5	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$64,148,814	\$13,423	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$8,933,923	\$1,886	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$4,756,969	\$1,004	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$3,618,958	\$764	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$3,652,034	\$771	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$4,847,523	\$1,023	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$8,353,488	\$1,763	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$3,778,761	\$1,744	\$1,159
Food services	\$283,137	\$60	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$1,833,556	\$387	\$151
Total	\$104,207,164	\$21,805	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$6,217,117	20.1	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,777,971	12.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$5,468,574	17.7	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$3,777,203	12.2	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$3,318,411	10.7	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$6,948,694	22.5	22.5
Supplies	\$106,151	0.3	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,258,140	4.1	7.2
Equipment	\$20,537	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$30,892,797	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		29.6	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	95.5
State	3.0
Federal	1.1
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	19	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	17	*
Students with Disabilities	81	87.7
District	360	97.2
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	95.4	258	78.9
Male	95.1	287	78.4
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	91.4	21	60.0
White	95.3	481	79.9
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	9	*
Students with Disabilities	84.6	58	35.8
District	95.2	545	78.6
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2021 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2021

* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	91.9	98.6
Male	82.6	94.6
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	87.5	97.2
English Learners	N/A	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	82.2	96.5
District	87.5	96.6
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	1.6%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	3.6%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	65.5%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	78.6%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		99.6%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		97.2%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		97.1%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		87.5%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		63.6%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	97.1%	-3.1%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Continuous improvement is a hallmark of the Darien Public Schools. Goals for the current year support the continuation of building a culture of professional learning and collaboration as strategic planning efforts help shape a new District mission, vision and core values and goals. The newly adopted Vision of the Graduate will also guide the District's work in the years ahead.

Professional learning is at the heart of District improvement efforts. Whether working in teams, collaborating with Teachers College or engaging in other forms of job-embedded professional development, the talented faculty demonstrate high-quality instruction and commitment to learning. The District continues to focus on utilizing instructional technology to enhance learning for students.

Darien prioritizes and practices the advancement of learner-centered practices to engage students and improve learning. With a continuous commitment to providing quality PK-12 supports and interventions, teachers and specialists work together to provide dynamic differentiated instruction grounded in student performance data. Additionally, the District values co-teaching as an instructional model to support populations of special learners.

Darien is known for providing an excellent and dynamic curriculum as the foundation to an exceptional learning experience. Therefore, curriculum revision is always a goal to ensure teachers are current and students have access to a guaranteed and viable program of study. Commitment to curriculum represents reflective practice and commitment to high-quality pedagogy and assessment practices.

Communication and outreach with families plays an important role in District processes. In addition to an updated website, systems for messaging and regular public meetings, the District benefits from an impressive parent network that supports student learning at both the school and District levels. Parents lend their talents and resources to the schools and are included in the decision making process. The District also works closely with many town organizations to support the needs of families and students to support engagement in school and their social and emotional health. The District strives to continuously improve systems for communication with parents and the community so that everyone has a clear picture of the district philosophy and programs. Decisions are made in the best interests of all students.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

In order to address racial, ethnic, and economic isolation, Darien has worked with strategic partners to optimize conditions for the learning community. Collaborating with various organizations allows for ongoing professional learning for staff, essential education for students and strategies to make systemic improvements for equity and access.

The District has engaged in a variety of experiences for students across diverse communities. Recent opportunities for students include participation in The Center for Global Study Interdistrict Magnet Program, the Regional Center for the Arts Magnet; The Westhill Vocational Agriculture Program; the Stamford Academy of IT & Engineering; the Western Region CMEA HS Music Festival; FCIAC HS competitions; and CSDE Interdistrict Music Composition Program.

Additionally, students interact with peers across communities through school-sponsored clubs and activities including debate team; DECA; robotics club; Ultimate Frisbee; JETS, math team; Model Congress; and Model UN. Participation in the A Better Chance Program; Respect for Differences; Building with Books; Person-to-Person; the Anti-Defamation League's NAMES Program; and the China Youth Exchange. Darien's comprehensive athletic and arts programs foster important opportunities for peer relationships beyond Darien. Students from other communities reside in Darien and go to the District schools through participation in the ABC Program. provide additional learning opportunities for students.

Through student-led organizations, like student council and government, students connect with local agencies to support social initiatives for children & their families in neighboring towns. Across grade levels and content areas, students experience learning to raise their social awareness and understanding of diverse perspectives. As curriculum is revised, Darien continues to build an understanding of diversity as a reflection of society and the ever-changing world.

Efforts to celebrate diversity and reduce racial and ethnic isolation have been identified as priorities for consideration of inclusion in the development of the District's strategic plan.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Darien School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Darien Board of Education recognizes the need to provide an equitable education for all students. Darien develops and supports policies and practices that ensure access to resources at all buildings. The annual budget appropriates funding for programming supporting comprehensive and inclusive offerings that are aligned to a rigorous curriculum. Funding formulas ensure equity in budgeting among the five elementary schools. This year, the District allocated resources to meet the needs of students through a variety of learning platforms and settings as a result of the global health pandemic. The District takes great pride in the quality of instruction and the frequency of in person learning made available to all students.

Darien adheres to class size guidelines and ensures resources, materials, and high-quality educators are in place with consistency. Initiatives are identified through system-wide planning & curriculum evaluation processes that are communicated with transparency to all stakeholders. District data teams support the work of understanding the varying needs of the student population. Data are disaggregated to support decision making for equity and access. Plans and